

Participant Handout: DevOps Culture Transformation Workshop

Workshop Purpose

This workshop helps you experience the difference between a traditional siloed Dev–Ops model and a modern DevOps collaborative culture. You will simulate work, identify bottlenecks, and redesign the system to improve flow, trust, and delivery speed.

1. Simulation Setup

Roles:

- Developers
- Operations / ITSM
- Senior Leader (approval gate)
- Observers (Architect / Manager)

Materials:

- Sticky notes
- Markers
- Whiteboard or wall

2. Work Items You Will Use

Features:

- AI Dashboard Upgrade
- API Security Patch
- Login Bug Fix
- Data Pipeline Optimization

Incidents:

- Production outage
- Latency spike
- Security alert

3. Phase 1: Current State Simulation

Rules:

- Dev and Ops cannot talk directly
- All communication goes through the Senior Leader
- Ops can reject work

- Senior Leader must approve everything
- Work moves one item at a time

Flow:

Dev → Senior Leader → Ops → Production

What You Will Experience:

- Delays
- Rework
- Miscommunication
- Incident pressure
- Bottlenecks

4. Observation & Reflection

Observe:

- Where does work wait?
- Who becomes the bottleneck?
- Why do incidents increase?
- Why is communication slow?

Common patterns:

- Delay: Senior Leader approval gate
- Blame: Dev vs Ops conflict
- Rework: Unclear requirements
- Incidents: Late feedback

5. Culture Diagnosis

- Silos
- Blame culture
- Low trust
- Poor visibility
- Reactive ITSM

Key Insight:

The system creates the behavior — not the people.

6. Phase 2: DevOps Transformation Simulation

New Rules:

- Dev + Ops collaborate directly
- No approval gate
- Shared responsibility
- Real-time discussion
- Work visible to everyone

New Flow:

Plan → Build → Test → Deploy → Monitor

What You Will Experience:

- Faster flow
- Fewer incidents
- Clear communication
- Shared ownership

7. Before vs After Comparison

- Delivery speed: Slow → Fast
- Communication: Low → High
- Blame: High → None
- Incidents: Frequent → Reduced
- Flow: Stopped → Smooth

8. Key Learning Outcomes

- Systems Thinking: Problems come from the system, not individuals
- Flow Awareness: Most delays come from waiting, not working
- Collaboration Improves Reliability
- Culture Drives Performance

9. Final Insight

When we changed the system, the behavior changed automatically.